

MAKING AI WORK FOR BHARAT

At a recent event, TCS highlighted how tech can help women and the youth scale barriers

BY TEAM BT

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES (TCS), India's biggest software services firm, is training rural women entrepreneurs in artificial intelligence (AI) to empower them financially. It organised the Tata AI Sakhi Immersion Program on the second day of the India AI Impact Summit 2026 in Delhi, bringing around 1,600 women village entrepreneurs and grassroots changemakers.

"With the AI for Sakhi programme, we are bringing all rural women entrepreneurs and teaching them AI and telling them how they can use AI to enhance the services they can provide to the rural population and thereby increasing and improving their own livelihood and the livelihood of the people taking all the government schemes in the rural parts of India," said Tata Consultancy Services MD & CEO K Krithivasan.

With AI Sakhi, TCS aims to break key barriers in AI adoption, said Krithivasan. "AI programming has been the forte of people who are comfortable in English. Now what we are doing is teaching people from non-English-speaking background on how they can use AI and develop soft-

ware," the TCS CEO explained.

Smriti Irani, former Union minister and founder and chairperson of Alliance for Global Good, lauded the initiative. "Women from across the country have been represented in the AI Sakhi Immersion programme, which helps women identify the use case of AI for their small businesses," Irani said, adding that the programme breaks age barriers as most of these women are above the age of 35.

AI-led design creation in jewelry is helping women artisans from rural India improve their livelihoods and grow their businesses, said Aarthi Subramanian, ED-President and Chief Operating Officer, TCS. "The Tata AI Sakhi programme is aimed at bringing AI to the hands of rural women. These are entrepreneurs who are providing last-mile support in the villages. These are karigars who are designing fashion jewelry. The whole thinking is how can AI empower them and help them in their daily lives," Subramanian added.

AI can be used by everyone for solving day-to-day problems, Union Minister of Electronics and IT Ashwini Vaishnaw said at the Tata Bharat YUVaI Hackathon, an event organ-

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